



Sylpheed 2.2.10

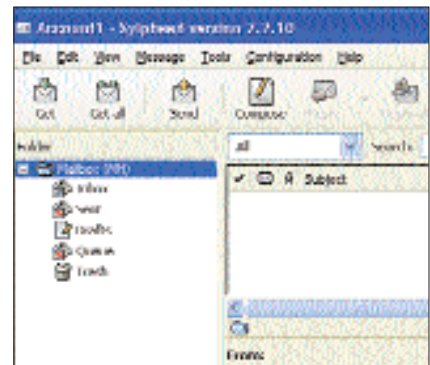
Sylpheed is an open source, cross-platform e-mail client that works with Windows as well as Linux. It not only supports all major protocols including RSS feeds, but also supports IPv6—the next-generation Internet Protocol.

The user interface is somewhat similar to that of Outlook Express, and is quite comfortable to work with. The usual Inbox, Sent, Draft, etc. folder structure is strikingly similar.

The mail composer lets you create new templates according to your needs. Messages can be composed only as text, but you can view HTML messages. You can either use the inbuilt editor or

bind and use an external editor for this purpose. Sylpheed's message editor cannot reflow text: it can only wrap it. Sylpheed takes care of your privacy issues by means of GnuPG keys for encrypted communication, in addition to TLS/SSL support.

The search feature is quite powerful, and allows you to save the results as a search folder. Spam is taken care of by means of bogofilter and bsfilter, which feature a learning function that improves their performance with use.



Sylpheed comes with a simple interface



The Bat! Home Edition

The Bat! Home Edition 3.85.03 was the one e-mail client that had a markedly different menu system. Unlike the usual File, Edit, etc. menus, here we have Messages, Specials, Accounts, etc.—much more relevant for an e-mail client. This may confuse the user at first, but it actually makes navigation much easier and faster.

Like most mail clients, The Bat! has support for POP3 and IMAP protocols. It can even connect to an MS Exchange Server using the MAPI protocol. The Message Dispatcher tool shows you the most important message headers, and lets you delete messages directly from the server. In some cases, the sender and subject might not be enough for you to decide whether you want to keep the message, so The Bat! can automatically download a few body lines together with the headers.

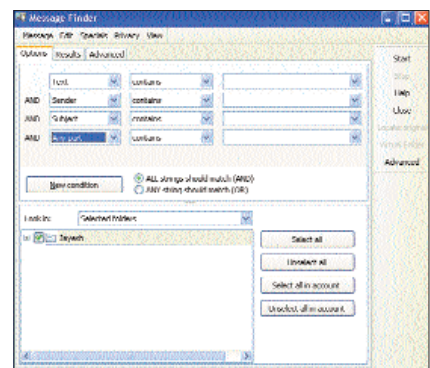
This version, unlike the previous versions, is capable of sending as well as receiving messages in the HTML format. The e-mail composer is also feature-rich; in fact, it is the only e-mail client we have seen that supports aligning even in plain-text mode. The spell-checker can even correct words based on phonetics!

You can set rules and search with seemingly endless options that yield highly refined results. A point to note is that though we have a large number of options, they are neatly named and thus not confusing. This multithreaded e-mail client can send as well as receive at the same time!

Mail Chat lets you chat with other The Bat! users by means of e-mail, so you remain protected from the potential threats posed by IMs. A flashing icon informs you about Mail Chat replies.

The Bat! is very secure against viruses and worms. It supports various PGP standards such as OpenPGP to encrypt your messages. You can also password-protect individual mailboxes if you wish.

With features such as Scheduler and Memo, The Bat! competes head-to-head with Outlook, and is good even for corporates and can also work as a server on your home network. Synchronisation and backups are also easily achievable. It costs \$24.50 (Rs 1,100), which is just right.



Extensive search options let you pinpoint your mail



Mozilla Thunderbird 1.5

Thunderbird is an open source, free e-mail client from the Mozilla Foundation. The interface is pretty simple and straightforward, and allows you to arrange mails into different virtual folders. E-mails can be sorted according to importance, time of reception, and even according to attachment. It has a themes-based interface, which means that the looks can be changed by applying themes.

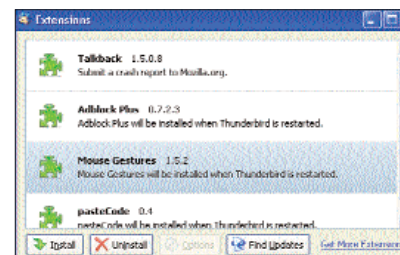
POP3 and IMAP are the supported mail protocols. In addition, it also supports NNTP, which lets you subscribe to Newsgroups. Like Firefox, it supports feeds from RSS 0.91 and Atom to keep you updated, and can be viewed as regular e-mails.

The search feature does not have too many parameters, but they seem to be adequate for a

home user. Message filters (rules) also do not have too many options, but a home user may be better off with the limited set of options.

This is a basic e-mail client like OE, while being less vulnerable to viruses because of the lack of ActiveX support. Pair this with the included Bayesian spam filter, and you have a very safe e-mail client.

We must also mention that Thunderbird supports a variety of plug-ins or extensions developed by the open source community. These extensions bring in new functionality and can enhance the client. Some extensions like the Adblock Plus filter block ads and increase system security, while others such as United States English Dictionary, add to the vocabulary of the e-mail composer.



Extensions are the meat of Thunderbird